

AI FOR THE WORK THAT MATTERS

**The 2027 AI playbook for purpose-driven marketing
and communications teams**

**How small teams can create more impact, move faster and stay
unmistakably human.**

THE CENTRAL IDEA

AI should not simply help your team produce more. It should create capacity for better thinking, stronger relationships and the work that creates real organisational impact.

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The opportunity is not "using AI". It is redesigning the marketing function.

Most marketing and communications teams are already using AI. The interesting question for 2027 is no longer whether someone can get a chatbot to write an email, generate ten headlines or summarise a report. Those things are useful, but they are incremental.

The larger opportunity is to redesign how work moves through the team: research, strategy, briefing, creation, approvals, distribution, optimisation and organisational learning.

THE GOAL IS NOT MORE MARKETING.

The goal is more mission: more of the organisation's finite human capacity directed toward the work that actually creates trust, understanding, participation, support and impact.

Three stages of AI maturity

Stage	What it looks like
AI-assisted	People do the work much as they always have, occasionally asking AI for help.
AI-enabled	AI is deliberately embedded into recurring workflows, with clear inputs, outputs and human review.
AI-native	The function has been redesigned around what humans and machines each do best.

For purpose-driven organisations, the prize is particularly large. Small teams can access capabilities that once required bigger budgets, specialist agencies and much larger departments. But only if they resist the temptation to use AI simply as a content factory.

What changes in 2027

AI is moving from an occasional productivity tool to an operating layer inside knowledge work. Marketing leaders do not need to predict every new model or platform. They do need to understand the direction of travel.

From prompts to systems

The advantage will not come from memorising clever prompt formulas. It will come from giving AI the right organisational context, using repeatable workflows and connecting it to approved sources of knowledge.

From chatbots to agents

AI will increasingly undertake multi-step tasks: gathering information, producing options, transforming formats, checking against rules and preparing work for human review.

From generic models to organisational intelligence

Your brand strategy, audience research, previous campaigns, policies, impact evidence and institutional knowledge become the context layer that makes AI useful to your organisation.

From content scarcity to content abundance

Generating something becomes trivial. Deciding what deserves to exist becomes more valuable.

From search engines to answer engines

Marketing teams need to think not only about whether people can find their website, but whether AI systems understand, trust and accurately represent their organisation.

From production skills to judgement skills

Taste, strategy, editing, verification, empathy and originality rise in value as first-draft production gets cheaper.

THE 2027 QUESTION

If everyone has access to the same models, what is uniquely yours? Usually: your knowledge, your relationships, your insight, your judgement and your ability to make something worth remembering.

The six jobs AI should do for your team

Do not organise your AI strategy around tools. Tools will change. Organise it around the jobs your team needs done.

Job	Examples
1. UNDERSTAND	Research, social listening, stakeholder sentiment, competitor analysis, audience synthesis, survey analysis, qualitative coding.
2. THINK	Strategy development, scenario testing, proposition development, campaign territories, challenging assumptions.
3. CREATE	Writing, design concepts, video, audio, repurposing, adaptation and accessibility.
4. PERSONALISE	Audience-specific communications, supporter journeys, fundraising messages and lifecycle communications.
5. OPERATE	Briefs, meeting summaries, campaign plans, reporting, approvals, project management and administrative work.
6. LEARN	Performance analysis, campaign retrospectives, institutional memory and extracting lessons from previous activity.

Think in maturity levels

Job	Bad AI use	Better AI use	AI-native use
Research	"Tell me about Gen Z donors."	Ask AI to analyse your existing research.	Maintain an approved, continuously updated audience intelligence environment.
Content	Generate 30 generic social posts.	Use AI to create channel adaptations from a strong human idea.	Build reusable content workflows with brand context, review rules and performance learning.
Reporting	Ask for a summary of a spreadsheet.	Have AI identify patterns and anomalies, then verify them.	Create a repeatable reporting workflow that turns campaign data into decisions and organisational learning.

Stop making more content

Generative AI has made content almost infinitely cheap. That changes the economics of marketing.

When everybody can create a plausible article, social post, image or email in seconds, volume stops being an advantage. The danger for marketing teams is obvious: use AI to fill every channel with more average material.

USE AI TO REMOVE LOW-VALUE WORK, NOT MULTIPLY LOW-VALUE WORK.

If AI saves ten hours and those ten hours become another thirty social posts nobody needed, you have not transformed anything.

Where the released capacity should go

- Better ideas and sharper strategy
- More time with communities, customers, donors, members and stakeholders
- Better stories and stronger creative direction
- More research and experimentation
- Better supporter and customer experiences
- More rigorous measurement and learning
- More time on the work only people can do

A simple test before generating anything

1. Would we have made this if AI did not make it cheap?
2. Who is it for, and what do we want them to think, feel or do?
3. Is there a distinctive idea here, or merely competent output?
4. What higher-value work are we not doing while we make this?

Build your organisational brain

Good AI output increasingly depends on context, not prompt tricks. A model with no knowledge of your organisation will tend toward plausible, generic marketing. A model grounded in your organisation can become far more useful.

The Marketing Knowledge Layer

A mature team gradually builds an approved knowledge environment containing the information AI needs to produce useful work, while excluding material that should not be exposed to an unapproved system.

Knowledge area	Examples
Brand	Brand strategy, positioning, tone of voice, key messages, visual principles.
Audience	Segmentation, research, personas, stakeholder needs, barriers, motivations.
Evidence	Impact data, approved claims, facts, statistics, research and citations.
Content	High-performing campaigns, content library, FAQs, speeches, reports, case studies.
Operations	Campaign processes, approval rules, channel requirements, templates and policies.
Learning	Past performance, post-campaign reviews, decisions, lessons and experiments.

GENERIC AI + GENERIC INTERNET = GENERIC MARKETING

AI + your organisational knowledge + strong human judgement can become a genuine capability.

Do not confuse knowledge with data dumping

The aim is not to pour every document, contact record or sensitive story into an AI system. The aim is to create a deliberately governed context layer: useful, current, structured and approved.

The human advantage

AI changes what people do at the keyboard. It does not change who is responsible for the work, and it does not remove the value of human judgement. In many areas it increases it.

AUTOMATE THE PREDICTABLE. AUGMENT THE ANALYTICAL. PROTECT THE HUMAN.

The best operating model does not ask "What can AI do?" It asks "Where does machine capability improve the work, and where does human presence create the value?"

What humans should own

Human advantage	Why it matters
Strategy	Choosing what matters, where to compete and what not to do.
Judgement	Knowing when an answer is technically plausible but strategically wrong.
Taste	Recognising work that is distinctive, memorable and worth publishing.
Empathy	Understanding context, emotion and lived experience beyond a pattern match.
Relationships	Trust is built between people, not generated at scale.
Ethical decisions	Consent, fairness, dignity and trade-offs require accountable human ownership.
Original observation	The most valuable ideas often begin with something a person noticed in the real world.
Creative direction	AI can make options. People decide which idea deserves to exist.
Accountability	A named person remains responsible for what goes out under the organisation's name.

Seven workflows every marketing team should redesign

The biggest gains come when AI is embedded into recurring work, not used ad hoc whenever somebody remembers to open a chatbot.

Campaign development

Research synthesis → opportunity framing → concept exploration → human creative direction → production → channel adaptation → performance learning.

Media and communications

Issue monitoring → source gathering → draft options → fact check → spokesperson input → approval → publication → coverage analysis.

Content production

Strong human brief → AI-assisted structure or variants → human edit → brand and fact check → adaptation → publishing → learning.

Fundraising/supporter communications

Audience insight → offer and story selection → AI-assisted variants → human rewrite → consent and claim checks → test → learn.

Audience research

Combine survey, interview and public research → AI-assisted coding and synthesis → human interpretation → insight brief → hypotheses for testing.

Reporting and optimisation

Ingest approved performance data → identify patterns → human verification → recommendation → experiment → institutionalise learning.

Executive/board communications

Gather approved source material → structure narrative → draft → executive judgement → evidence check → concise final communication.

DESIGN PRINCIPLE

Let AI do more of the gathering, formatting, pattern-finding and first-pass production. Keep humans closest to framing, judgement, relationships, consent, verification and final decisions.

Where purpose changes the rules

Purpose-driven organisations often trade on trust with donors, members, communities, funders and regulators. The people in their stories may be vulnerable. Their communications may influence decisions about health, welfare, donations or public support. That changes the risk profile.

Governance should not become the headline of the AI strategy. It should make confident use possible.

A simple task-risk model

Band	Principle	Typical examples
GREEN - ACCELERATE	Low risk, no sensitive data, easy to verify.	Meeting summaries, public research synthesis, internal drafts, accessibility adaptations, headline options, brainstorming.
AMBER - AUGMENT CAREFULLY	Useful, but errors, bias or context failures could reach people.	Public-facing copy, personalisation, translations, impact reporting, image generation, audience segmentation using approved data.
RED - PROTECT THE HUMAN	Trust, consent, safety or dignity are central.	Beneficiary stories, crisis replies, sensitive personal data, synthetic testimonials, fabricated impact, representations of real communities.

Questions to resolve in writing

5. What data never enters unapproved AI tools?
6. Which tools are approved, and for what purposes?
7. When must AI involvement be disclosed?
8. Who is accountable for external work?
9. How are factual claims verified?
10. How are bias, representation and consent reviewed?
11. What happens when something goes wrong?

The point is not to eliminate risk. It is to make the safe path obvious enough that people can move quickly without improvising the rules every time.

Your AI marketing operating system

Individual experimentation is not an operating model. A team becomes genuinely AI-enabled when five components work together.

Component	What good looks like
1. KNOWLEDGE	What AI is allowed to know about your organisation - and how that knowledge stays current.
2. TOOLS	The approved models and platforms your team can use for specific tasks.
3. WORKFLOWS	The recurring processes where AI has a defined role rather than an occasional cameo.
4. GUARDRAILS	Privacy, consent, accuracy, representation, approval and accountability rules.
5. CAPABILITY	What staff need to know: not just prompting, but briefing, editing, verification, judgement and workflow design.

One owner beats twenty enthusiasts

Name a person accountable for AI-enabled marketing, even if it is only part of their role. Their job is not to approve every prompt. It is to keep the system coherent: approved tools, current guidance, reusable workflows, lessons learned and capability development.

Train for judgement, not tricks

Prompting techniques will date quickly. The durable capability is the ability to frame a problem, provide good context, critique output, verify claims, improve the work and know when not to use AI at all.

Measure value, not usage

An AI program can look busy without creating any value. Licences, prompts and the volume of AI-generated content are activity measures, not impact measures.

Weak metrics

- Number of AI licences
- Number of staff trained
- Number of prompts
- Number of AI-generated assets
- Hours spent in AI tools

Better metrics

- Hours removed from low-value work
- Campaign development cycle time
- Cost per usable asset
- Research turnaround time
- Content reuse and adaptation speed
- Quality and error rates
- Conversion or engagement performance
- Staff capacity redirected to high-value work
- Stakeholder trust signals

THE HEADLINE TEST: BETTER WORK, NOT MORE OUTPUT

Is AI creating measurable capacity for better strategy, stronger relationships, higher-quality work and greater organisational impact - rather than simply increasing the volume of content?

A quarterly leadership review

12. Where did we use AI?
13. What did it save or improve?
14. Where did the released time or budget go?
15. What became better - not merely faster?
16. What failed, or nearly failed?
17. What should we stop, standardise or scale?

The 20-minute AI opportunity audit

Do this with your team before buying another tool. List the recurring activities that consume meaningful time each month, then score each against four questions.

Question	Score 1	Score 2	Score 3
How much time does it consume?	Low	Moderate	High
How repetitive is it?	Rare / bespoke	Some repetition	Highly repeatable
How much human judgement does it require?	Low	Moderate	High
What happens if AI gets it wrong?	Minor inconvenience	Rework / reputational risk	Material harm / trust / compliance risk

Then place each activity into one of four actions

Action	Use when	Examples
AUTOMATE	High volume, predictable, low consequence.	Formatting, first-pass summaries, routine transformations.
AUGMENT	High value, significant judgement, AI can improve speed or breadth.	Research, strategy development, campaign concepts, reporting.
PROTECT	High consequence or inherently human.	Consent, crisis communication, sensitive stories, final accountability.
STOP	Low value and unnecessary.	Reports nobody reads, duplicate content, legacy processes with no clear audience.

PRIORITISATION RULE

Do not start with 50 use cases. Start with five workflows that consume your team's time every week.

Your first 90 days

Days 1-30: Understand

- Map how staff are already using AI - without blame.
- Map the workflows that consume the most time.
- Identify sensitive data, trust and representation risks.
- Select the three to five highest-value opportunities.
- Agree the outcomes you want to improve: time, quality, speed, reach or learning.

Days 31-60: Build

- Choose approved tools and define their purposes.
- Create organisational AI instructions and a basic knowledge layer.
- Redesign the priority workflows with clear human checkpoints.
- Create reusable templates, context files and review steps.
- Train the team in briefing, editing, verification and judgement.

Days 61-90: Scale

- Measure what changed, not just whether people used AI.
- Improve the workflows based on real experience.
- Document successful patterns so the whole team can reuse them.
- Expand the organisational knowledge layer.
- Scale only what creates measurable value.

A GOOD FIRST QUARTER

By day 90, you should be able to point to a handful of recurring workflows that are clearly faster or better, with known guardrails, named owners and evidence of where the saved capacity went.

The AI-native marketing scorecard

This scorecard is a quick diagnostic for marketing and communications leaders. It is designed to show how mature your current AI operating model is across six areas: strategy, knowledge, workflow, people, trust and value. It is not a test of how many tools you use or how advanced your prompting is. It is a way to identify the few organisational gaps that will make the biggest difference next.

Complete it with the people who actually do the work - ideally as a leadership or team exercise rather than an individual judgement. Answer for what happens in practice, not what a policy or strategy says should happen.

HOW TO USE IT

Score each statement from 0 to 2: 0 = no or not yet; 1 = partly, inconsistently or informally; 2 = yes, consistently and repeatably. Add the scores for a total out of 24. Then use the result on the next page to decide what to fix first.

Dimension	Statement	Score
STRATEGY	We have defined what we want AI to improve, rather than simply encouraging experimentation.	0 / 1 / 2
STRATEGY	We have prioritised a small number of high-value workflows.	0 / 1 / 2
KNOWLEDGE	Our team can give AI approved, current organisational context.	0 / 1 / 2
KNOWLEDGE	We know which information must never enter unapproved tools.	0 / 1 / 2
WORKFLOW	AI is embedded into repeatable processes, not just individual prompting.	0 / 1 / 2
WORKFLOW	Successful AI workflows are documented and reusable across the team.	0 / 1 / 2
PEOPLE	Staff can brief, challenge, edit and verify AI output effectively.	0 / 1 / 2
PEOPLE	We are deliberately building judgement and creative direction skills.	0 / 1 / 2
TRUST	We have clear rules for privacy, consent, accuracy, representation and disclosure.	0 / 1 / 2
TRUST	A named person remains accountable for external work.	0 / 1 / 2
VALUE	We measure time, quality or performance improvements from AI-enabled work.	0 / 1 / 2

Dimension	Statement	Score
VALUE	We can explain where released capacity or budget has been redirected.	0 / 1 / 2

What your score means - and what to do next

Score	Stage	Focus
0-7	Experimenting	AI use is mostly ad hoc. Start by mapping what people are already doing, choose 2-3 recurring workflows and establish basic tool, data and accountability rules.
8-14	AI-assisted	Useful practice exists, but it depends on individuals. Standardise the strongest workflows, give AI better organisational context and build team capability in judgement and verification.
15-19	AI-enabled	AI is becoming part of how work gets done. Connect successful workflows, strengthen measurement, document what works and expand the knowledge layer that supports them.
20-24	AI-native	Your foundations are strong. Focus on continuous improvement, deeper integration, measurable value and protecting the judgement, voice and relationships that make your organisation distinctive.

Do not treat the total as the only answer. Look for your lowest-scoring dimension: that is usually the best place to start. A team with strong tools and workflows but weak trust controls has a different priority from one with good governance but no repeatable use cases. Revisit the scorecard every six months to see whether capability is becoming embedded rather than merely expanding.

Make more room for the work that matters

AI gives small purpose-driven marketing and communications teams capabilities that previously required much larger teams and budgets. But the biggest benefit will not come from generating more content or teaching everyone a better prompt formula.

It will come from redesigning how people, knowledge and technology work together.

The best teams will use AI to compress low-value work, expand their capacity to understand and learn, improve the speed and quality of execution, and create more room for the human work that builds trust.

THE STANDARD TO AIM FOR

Less time producing what machines can do. More time deciding what matters. More time with the people you serve. Better ideas. Better judgement. Better marketing - with more of your team's capacity directed to the work that matters.

What would an AI-native version of your marketing team look like?

Memery helps purpose-driven organisations redesign their marketing and communications functions around AI - identifying the best opportunities, building practical workflows, creating organisational knowledge systems, establishing sensible guardrails and training teams to use them.

BOOK AN AI MARKETING OPPORTUNITY WORKSHOP

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